

# World *Robotics* Service Robots

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## 2026

incl. Mobile and Medical Robots



Statistics, Market Analysis, List of Manufacturers and  
Case Studies

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## World Robotics 2026 – Service Robots

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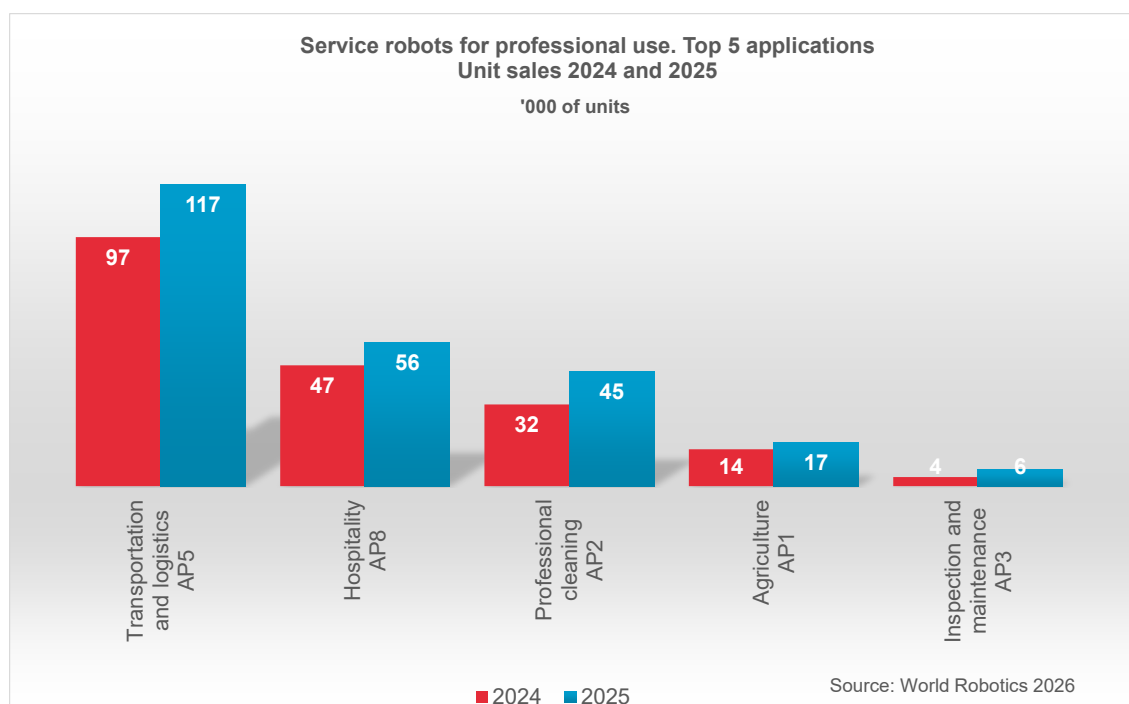
## Executive Summary World Robotics 2026 - Service Robots

The service robot industry continues to be highly diverse, with applications ranging from logistics and professional cleaning to agriculture, healthcare, hospitality, and emerging humanoid robots. The IFR Statistical Department is currently aware of more than 1,000 service robot producers worldwide. This excludes integrators and prototyping services.

In 2025, worldwide sales of professional service robots (excluding medical robots) increased by 24%. At the same time, Robotics-as-a-Service (RaaS) continued to gain importance with a high double-digit growth rate. Economic uncertainty, high upfront investment costs, and the need for greater operational flexibility are supporting the adoption of subscription- and usage-based business models. RaaS makes automation more accessible, particularly for small and medium-sized enterprises, while allowing companies to scale robotic operations according to demand.

### *Top applications for professional service robots*

The five largest application groups for professional service robots in 2025 were transportation and logistics (AP5), hospitality (AP8), professional cleaning (AP2), agriculture (AP1), and inspection and maintenance (AP3).



**Transportation and logistics** remained by far the largest professional application group. Nearly every second professional service robot sold in 2025 was built for the transportation of goods or cargo. Mobile robot-based order fulfillment solutions are accelerating installations worldwide, while emerging applications such as truck loading

and unloading, outdoor transportation, and cleanroom logistics provide additional opportunities for future growth.

Demand for **hospitality robots** (AP8) also increased strongly. Mobile guidance, information, and telepresence robots continue to account for most sales, while food and drink preparation is emerging as a promising new field. Labor shortages, rising operating costs, and increasing demand for consistent food production are expected to accelerate robot adoption in corporate cafeterias, hospitals, airports, convenience retail, quick-service restaurants, and other professional environments. Social interaction robots for professional use are also becoming increasingly viable as advances in generative AI and large language models (LLMs) improve their capabilities.

Demand for **professional cleaning robots** (AP2) expanded particularly strongly. Growth was driven mainly by floor cleaning robots, reflecting the strong potential for automation and scalability in this application. At the same time, new products are entering the market, including outdoor sweepers and professional robotic lawn mowers. These solutions are particularly attractive for municipalities seeking to maintain parks and public spaces while facing a shrinking workforce. Declining product prices and the increasing availability of RaaS models are expected to further lower adoption barriers.

**Agricultural robots** (AP1) also returned to solid growth in 2025. Labor shortages and climate change continue to be major drivers of automation, while advances in intelligent vision systems are expected to accelerate the adoption of robots for precision farming. Current growth is increasingly supported by barn cleaning and feeding robots in addition to the established markets for cultivation and milking robots. High upfront capital expenditure, difficult outdoor environments, and gaps in rural connectivity nevertheless remain important barriers to broader adoption.

The market for **inspection and maintenance robots** (AP3) recorded another year of exceptionally strong expansion. Recent advances in artificial intelligence, sensor technology, and autonomous navigation are enabling robots to perform inspection tasks in hazardous and hard-to-access environments with increasing autonomy. The need to maintain and modernize critical infrastructure is expected to continue driving demand in this market.

### *Medical robots*

The market for **medical robots** continued to offer attractive growth opportunities in 2025. Surgical robotics was a particularly important driver, while exoskeletons also recorded a substantial increase in unit sales. Demographic change is expected to remain one of the most important long-term market drivers. Population aging simultaneously reduces the availability of healthcare personnel and increases demand for medical treatment and support. Robotics applications are therefore expanding beyond traditional surgical systems into laboratory automation, rehabilitation, elderly care, and other healthcare-related services.

### *Consumer use robots*

Service robots for **consumer use** continued to represent a mass market and recorded strong growth in 2025. Robots for domestic tasks remain by far the largest category, led by robotic vacuum cleaners. Window cleaning robots also developed dynamically, while robotic lawn mowers and pool cleaning robots serve smaller but well-established consumer markets. Advances in functionality are supporting demand, although cybersecurity requirements, trade restrictions, sustainability considerations, and increasing product complexity are becoming important challenges for manufacturers.

Artificial intelligence is also revitalizing the market for **social interaction robots**. While many earlier social robots struggled to achieve widespread adoption because of high costs and limited functionality, recent progress in generative AI and especially large language models is creating new opportunities for AI-powered social companions. The education robot market remains promising as parents and teachers worldwide place increasing emphasis on STEM education.

### *Humanoid robots*

A major new area covered by World Robotics is the emerging market for **humanoid robots**. Almost 6,900 humanoids were reported sold globally in 2025, with the overwhelming majority originating from companies headquartered in Asia. The market is still at a very early stage: many companies offer humanoids primarily for testing, research, and pilot projects rather than for broad commercial deployment. The IFR Statistical Department is currently aware of 171 humanoid robot manufacturers, illustrating the considerable entrepreneurial activity surrounding this technology.

Humanoid robotics is also one of the youngest parts of the robotics industry. A large share of identified manufacturers was established only in recent years, with a pronounced wave of new company formation emerging alongside advances in generative artificial intelligence. Whether all of today's developers will achieve market readiness remains uncertain, making humanoids one of the most dynamic fields to watch over the coming years.

### *Outlook*

Across service robotics, the underlying drivers remain powerful. Demographic change, persistent labor shortages, rising labor costs, advances in artificial intelligence and sensor technology, and the need to improve productivity are creating opportunities for automation across an expanding range of applications. At the same time, geopolitical uncertainty, trade restrictions, cybersecurity requirements, regulation, and high investment costs can slow down adoption. Flexible business models such as RaaS can help overcome some of these barriers and are expected to gain further importance.

The service robotics market therefore combines established high-volume applications with a growing number of specialized and emerging solutions. Some application groups have already reached considerable scale, while others are only beginning to transition from technological development to commercial deployment. World Robotics Service Robots 2026 provides detailed statistics by application, region, and business model, complemented by market assessments and outlooks for the major segments. The report also provides an in-depth analysis of the global service robotics industry and the companies shaping its future.